

Learning the Power of Teamwork through Volunteering

2024 - 2026

Role/Position

Community Volunteer and Mentor

Publication Link

My Complete Volunteering History:
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/sulhanfuadi/details/volunteering-experiences/>

Google I/O Extended 2024 Highlights:
https://www.linkedin.com/posts/sulhanfuadi_googledevelopergroup-gdgsemarang-googleioextended2024-activity-7254538203934646272-TLS8

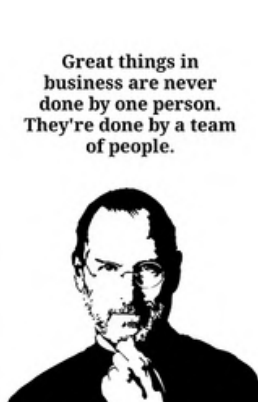
JuaraGCP 2024 Workshop Story:
https://www.linkedin.com/posts/sulhanfuadi_gdg-gdgsemarang-googlecloudcomputing-activity-7255787955363983360-5ZKp

DevFest Semarang 2024 Recap:
https://www.linkedin.com/posts/sulhanfuadi_googledevelopergroup-gdgsemarang-googledevfest2024-activity-7270813060343177216-8CTK

Artwork Description

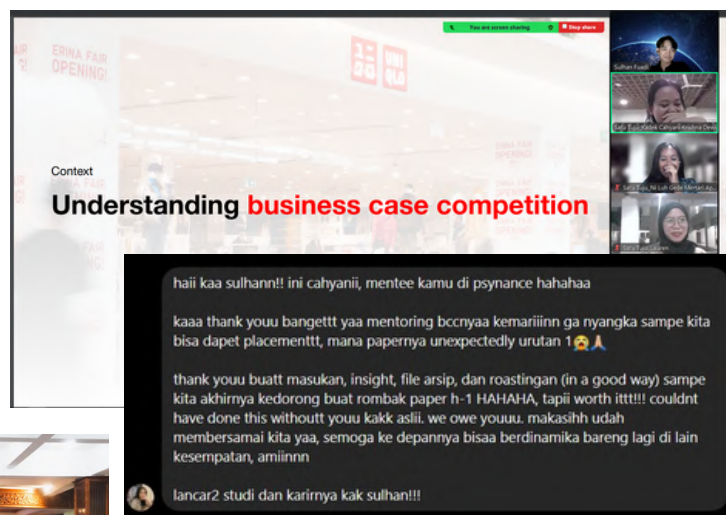
The Why

To be completely honest, I used to hate working with other people. I always preferred being a lone wolf because I saw collaboration as a hassle that just added unnecessary weight to my work. I genuinely believed I could finish tasks faster and better on my own. However, I noticed that the creators and leaders I valued the most saw teamwork as an incredibly powerful tool. Even Steve Jobs famously said, "Great things in business are never done by one person, they are done by a team of people". Hearing a statement like that from someone I respected made me think that something might be wrong with my own beliefs. I decided to step out of my comfort zone and try volunteering as an experiment to find out if building things with others was actually worth it.



The How

I threw myself into several community roles to test this new path. I served as a Google Student Ambassador for my campus, acted as a final round judge for a software development competition, and moderated the Google Developers Community Discord server in Indonesia. While all of these roles taught me something new, two specific volunteer experiences changed my perspective completely. First, I joined the core volunteer team for massive annual events with Google Developer Group Semarang, including DevFest and Google I/O Extended. Second, I signed up as a Business Case Mentor for a national competition called Psynance 2025, organized by the BEM Faculty of Psychology at Universitas Indonesia.



The What

These experiences completely shattered my old lone wolf mindset. Working with GDG Semarang showed me the true meaning behind the words of Steve Jobs. Organizing huge events like DevFest required a clear vision, multiple specialized teams, and constant weekly syncs to keep everyone moving together. It was physically impossible for a single person to pull off an event of that scale. This hands-on experience proved to me that massive, great things truly require a team.

The second breakthrough came from mentoring a student group named Team Satu Tuju at the Universitas Indonesia competition. I gave them intense feedback and constructively critiqued their ideas, which pushed them to completely rework their business paper just one day before the deadline. They ended up winning second place overall and first place for best paper. However, the trophies were not the main reward for me. The real impact came from a heartfelt text message from one of the mentees thanking me for membersamai them and pushing them to their limits because it made their sacrifice worth it. In that exact moment, I felt a deep sense of personal and emotional fulfillment. I finally understood what Steve Jobs meant when he talked about putting a dent in the universe. I realized that the real magic of building things with others is the positive impact you leave on human lives.



Chasing Competitions: Finding Value Beyond the Prize Money

2023 - 2025

Role/Position

Team Leader and Tech-Business Strategist

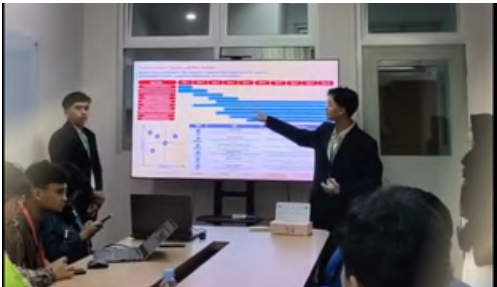
Publication Link

My Complete Awards & Honors History:
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/sulhanfuadi/details/honors/>

Artwork Description

The Why

If you looked at my calendar back in 2023, you would see a student desperate to solve a very practical problem: paying for college. My initial spark for entering competitions had absolutely nothing to do with saving the world or mastering complex tech. It was a survival mechanism to tackle my tuition fees. I saw hackathons and business challenges as fast-paced arenas where I could pitch my brains for prize money and hopefully secure a merit scholarship. I needed a way to prove my worth quickly, and the competition stage looked like the fastest shortcut.



The How

Driven by that financial target, I jumped headfirst into every national web development, UI/UX, and business case competition I could find. I became the guy who formed teams, recruited potential talent, and led our product strategy from a blank page to the final presentation pitch. We traded sleep for Figma prototypes and debated features late into the night. But a funny thing happens when you compete that much: you fail. A lot. I lost so many times that the names of those failed projects have completely blurred together. Yet, somewhere between the messy defeats and the occasional podium finishes, the game evolved for me. I stopped just looking at the cash prize and started falling in love with the sheer chaos of breaking down problems and building solutions under tight deadlines.



We are happy to announce our...

UI/UX

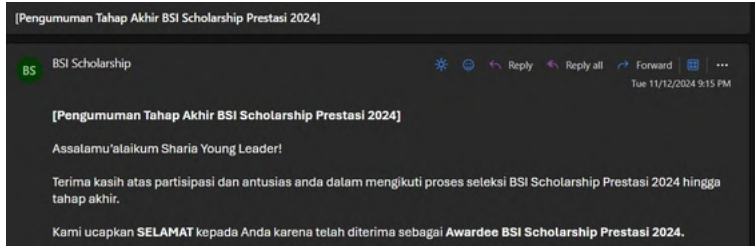
Mini Competition Winners!

- 1 Sulhan Fuadi
- 2 Aileen Josephine H.
- 3 Jilan Ablah Hanifah

The What

In November 2024, my original mission came full circle when I stood among the top 100 awardees out of 10,000+ national applicants to become a BSI Scholarship Prestasi Awardee. It was the massive financial relief I had been chasing for months. But by the time the scholarship landed, my mindset had completely transformed. I realized that when your ultimate goal is simply to experience and learn, every single outcome is a win.

Losing lost its sting, and winning became a natural byproduct of pushing my own boundaries. This mental shift gave me the confidence to take on much bigger stages, leading to a string of milestones like winning the GDSC UI competition, the COMPFEST 17 case challenge, and taking 2nd place at the MCE ITB 2025 Business Case Competition. At ITB, I collaborated with total strangers, blending their financial data with my own tech-business framework to build a predictive maintenance ecosystem. What started as a frantic race to pay my bills ended up defining who I am today: a resilient builder who genuinely lives for the thrill of creating products with others.



Rebuilding the Builder: Turning an Accident into My Greatest Asset

2025-2026

Role/Position

Full-Time Bedrest Patient
& Bed-Based Builder

Publication Link

My Personal Reflection Essay:
<https://sulhanfuadi.substack.com/p/reflections-on-fracture-femur-sinistra>

Artwork Description

The Why

On May 13, 2025, I was on my way back to my college dorm in Semarang after a short holiday in my hometown of Magelang. Mid-journey, my life hit a literal wall. I got into a severe collision with a massive truck. In the split second I saw the truck heading straight into my lane, I genuinely thought I was going to die. Thankfully, I survived, but I walked away with a severe broken bone as a very lovely parting gift from the crash -- a left thigh fracture, clinically known as a *fraktur femur sinistra*. Before this happened, I was completely trapped in a toxic hustle culture loop. My entire existence was just work, work, and barely any rest. This sudden, violent stop forced an immense amount of empty space into my calendar, which eventually became the most powerful turning point of my life.

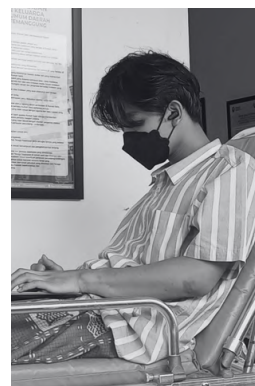
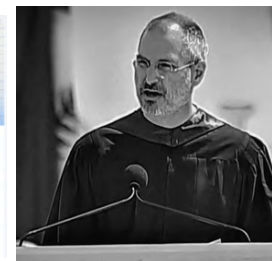
The How

Instead of letting my room become a space for self-pity, I chose to treat my recovery period as an unexpected canvas. With my leg in a cast and a laptop propped up on my blankets, I used the empty hours to focus purely on things that felt essential. I spent my days reading essays, writing down my thoughts, and diving into casual vibe-coding sessions. I even started joining national tech and business case competitions straight from my bed. It was a season of deep mental reset -- just enough reflection, mind you, not the endless corporate type mentioned by Marc Andreessen 🤖. I used this quiet time to actively rebuild my baseline understanding of family, hope, and what it actually means to be anti-fragile when your physical world stands still.

The What

This forced pause completely upgraded who I am, making me realize that the most important product I will ever build is myself. The near-death experience made me deeply understand what Steve Jobs said during his 2005 Stanford commencement address: "Your time is limited, so don't waste it living someone else's life. Don't be trapped by dogma which is living with the results of other people's thinking. Don't let the noise of others' opinions drown out your own inner voice."

The accident stripped away my fear of failure. While still in my recovery phase, I managed to finish my expert-tier project in the IDCamp 2024 backend path, got selected as a Google Student Ambassador for my campus, and led my teams to win Best Case Team at COMPFEST 17 Universitas Indonesia and 2nd place at MCE ITB 2025. I also published my personal notes in an article titled "reflections on fracture femur sinistra" to help future accident survivors find their mental strength. I left that bed not just with a healed bone, but as a much braver, independent, and anti-fragile builder.



Bhaskara Jala Dhananjaya · 1st
Product Management at BRI | Marketing Communication at UIUXINDO | Product & UI/UX Mentor | BNSP Certified
October 6, 2025, Bhaskara was Sulhan's mentor

Mentored Sulhan during COMPFEST 17's Graduation Night project, and he was one of the most proactive members on the team. He actively contributed to secondary research, shaped the problem statement, and consistently took the initiative to reach out whenever we needed to dig deeper into the roadmap or refine our strategy. He's the kind of teammate who is not only reliable, but also genuinely curious and quick to act on feedback. He made solid contributions across the board and is highly recommended for any product team.



Muhammad Nur Ihsan · 1st
Grab Support at Grab | Ex- ParagonCorp, Maersk JV, PNP, Infra MM | Founder & CEO Belajar.BCC | Top 5 Most Outstanding Students FT UI | 10+ Winner of Business Competitions
September 13, 2025, Muhammad Nur was Sulhan's mentor

Watching Sulhan lead his team to win 1st Place in the Akademi Business Case Batch 3 was a highlight for me as a mentor. His ability to grasp complex problems was immediately clear, but his work on the Paragon Corp case was truly standout. He guided his team to an analysis so thorough it earned them a perfect score, and he was brilliant at turning those complex findings into a simple, powerful solution.

Suhan Fuadi

Universitas Diponegoro - Informatics
(Student, 6th Semester)

Contact Information

[Linkedln](#)
sulhanfuadi.dev@gmail.com

Portfolio Submission for
Apple Developer Academy
Indonesia

Aksa: Building a Startup from Scratch with "the crazy one"

2026

Role/Position

Co-founder, CTO,
and Chief Argument Officer

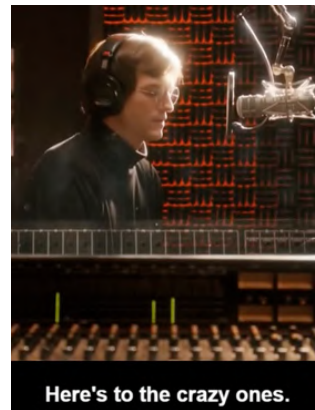
Publication Link

Our Startup Platform:
joinaksa.com/welcome

Artwork Description

The Why

I jumped into building Aksa because of my co-founder. He is exactly the kind of person Steve Jobs described in his famous "Here's to the crazy ones" quote -- the misfits, the rebels, the troublemakers, and the ones who see things differently. He is a top student at Mawapres FEB UNDIP, a year older than me, a Hafiz who has memorized the entire 30 juz of the Quran, and absolutely obsessed with the startup game. His raw drive and refusal to accept the status quo rubbed off on me. We both felt that online learning was fundamentally broken and lonely, so we teamed up to change it. Our goal was to create a social upskilling network centered around creator-led communities, a place where people could actually learn and grow together.



Here's to the crazy ones.

The How

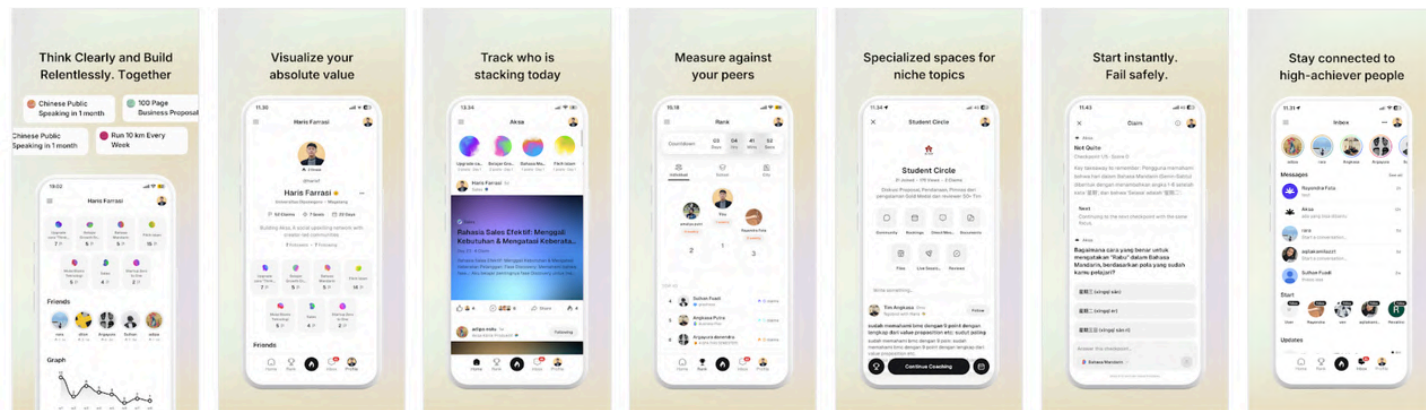
As the Co-founder and CTO, my job was to turn our wild whiteboard ideas into actual functional code. I started by building the entire web platform end-to-end, handling everything from the backend architecture to the user screens. Our journey consisted of routine founder syncs, intense weekly team meetings, and honestly, fighting each other about 90% of the time.

But as we grew, we had a major realization: the real heartbeat of Aksa isn't just a static course catalog, it's the network itself. We are essentially building a niche social media platform, and we all know that the true power of social media belongs on your phone, not a desktop browser. Because of this, I pivoted our technical roadmap and expanded our development beyond just a website. I threw myself into building our mobile applications for both Android and iOS so our users could connect and interact naturally on the go.

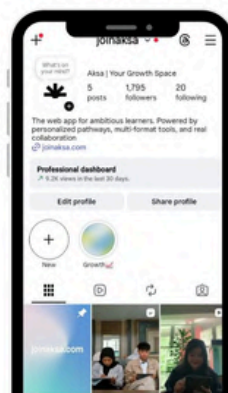
The What

The game was brutal at first. We got rejected by a long list of funding sources and investors. But we treated every single "no" as a data point to iterate our product. Our persistence finally paid off when we secured national entrepreneurship funding through the P2MW 2026 grant from the Ministry.

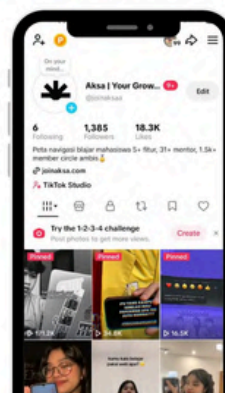
Beyond the funding and growing the platform to 24 creators and 715+ users, the real impact was how this journey rewired my brain. If I had never built Aksa with my co-founder and faced the challenge of scaling a web-to-mobile platform, I would have never deeply studied the lessons of Paul Graham, the startup playbooks of Sam Altman, or the raw grit of builders like Travis Kalanick, Amjad Masad, and Steve Jobs. We successfully changed each other, and I learned what it truly takes to stay in the ring and build something out of nothing.



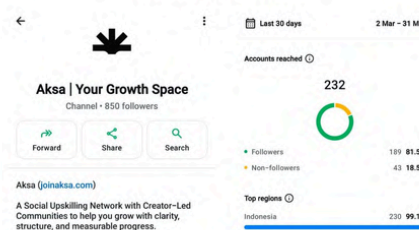
Instagram



TikTok



Whatsapp Channel



Weekly Feedback Call dengan Kreator



Role/Position

Product Engineer
and Chief Self-Curator

Publication Link

My Personal Space:
sulhanfuadi.com

Artwork Description

The Why

To be completely fair, I mostly put this here because I wanted to show off that I actually have a lot of other tech projects, but didn't want to turn this portfolio into a boring wall of code repositories. I've built standalone iOS and watchOS apps, but I chose to leave them out of these five main slots because my human stories -- like surviving a truck crash or fighting with my startup co-founder -- felt way more meaningful. But since it'd be a total shame if those tech projects went completely unnoticed, I'm using my personal website as a sneaky proxy to pass them through, haha. As Naval Ravikant once said, intelligence is getting what you want out of life, and this website is just me applying that rule to this application.

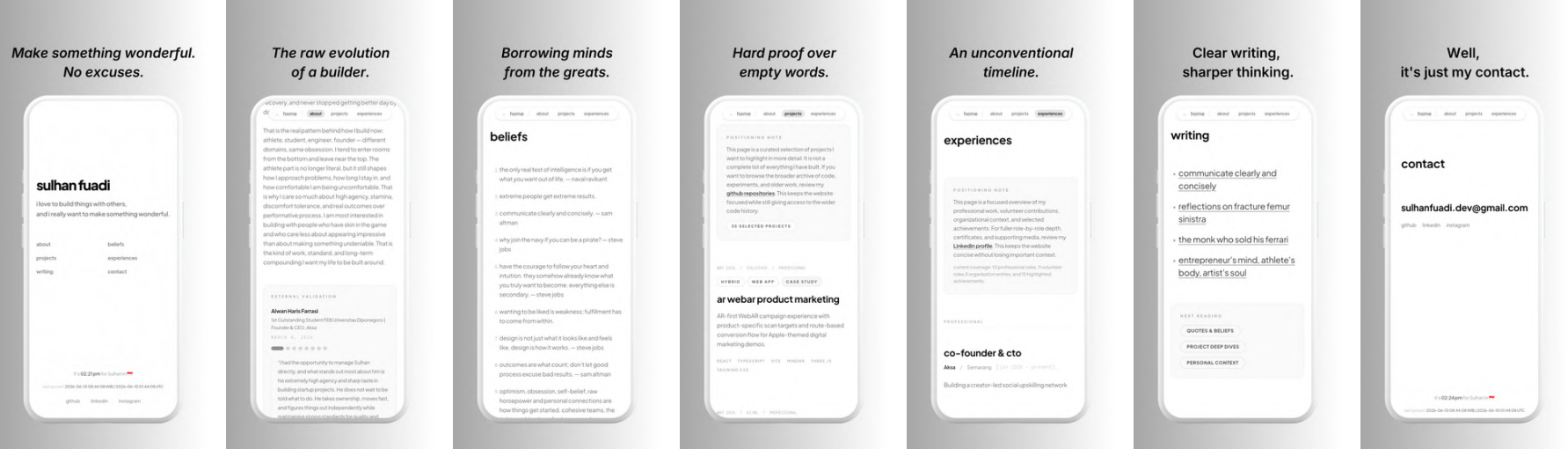
The How

I engineered my personal website to serve as a clear and concise mirror of my entire journey. Instead of making a messy page, I organized everything into seven essential points directly on the platform:

- 1. Core Principle: My main motto—"I love to build things with others, and I really want to make something wonderful"—right on the homepage.
- 2. About: A short story about me, explaining strongly how I became a builder.
- 3. Beliefs: My life principles, which are mostly from tech founders and builders.
- 4. Projects: The products I've made, explaining what I have successfully built as a builder.
- 5. Experiences: What I have done, showing how crazy my journey has been compared to most people my age.
- 6. Writing: The things I've learned—well, Paul Graham and Sam Altman did this, so I did it too.
- 7. Contact: Well, it's just my contact.

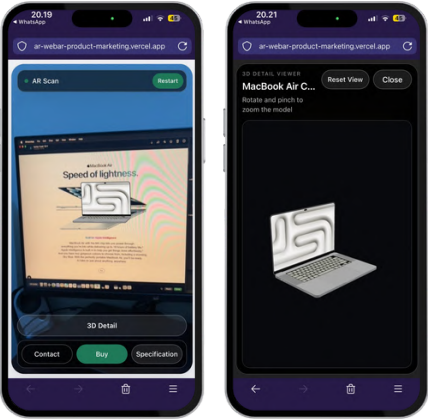
The What

The end result is a curated digital ecosystem that perfectly captures my identity as a builder. It acts as a live proof of my development skills and design taste, wrapped into an accessible user interface. Instead of just handing over a static resume with standard bullet points, I created a living archive that highlights how intensely I have run my life experiments compared to the average student. It serves as the final punctuation mark of my application. If you want to explore the rest of my web, mobile, and watch configurations that did not fit into this document, the entire playground is open for you at sulhanfuadi.com.



too good to leave unseen, haha:

AR WebAR
Web-based AR
marketing project



CalmPulse BP
watchOS stress
management app



Teman Tuli
Live captions for
Deaf students

